

LibreOffice Online launched for ownCloud Server

CODE (Collabora Online Development Edition) is a tool designed to give its users a virtual machine. The tool is based on the LibreOffice Online project and the open source ownCloud Server self-hosting cloud storage solution. The companies made a joint announcement regarding the initial preview of CODE. This collaboration will permit users to edit office documents like Word, spreadsheets, and presentations through the Web-based interface of ownCloud. "LibreOffice Online is what the name suggests - an online version of the well-known LibreOffice suite of productivity apps. 'Collabora and LibreOffice Online' integrated into ownCloud Server brings these powerful productivity features to ownCloud users. No other cloud technology offers the quality of rendering that LibreOffice brings to the browser, and this development edition already offers a wide range of features, with more to come," said the Collabora representatives.



Jos Poortvliet, ownCloud community manager, informed Softpedia that Collabora had employed a team of developers for the LibreOnline project to include more features into it, and also to employ LibreOffice Online for ownCloud on a large scale.

Speculation is on about whether the LibreOnline tool may soon vanish as CODE gets released.

What will KDE Plasma 5.6 feature?



One of the developers of the KDE Plasma 5.6 release has stated that the new release will have a lot more user-friendliness, as it will not have any functionality that inhibits users from accomplishing their daily goals.

The new version is going to be borrowing the Unity API from Canonical's Ubuntu Linux OS to implement support for app notifications in the Task Manager. For instance, the download progress will be displayed in the Chromium browser. However, the KDE developers will be extending the functions of several of the applications in its software suite—for instance, Dolphin, for displaying the file transfer progress in the Task Manager.

It will also be supported by other third party apps which include Telegram or Mozilla Thunderbird. KDE Plasma 5.6 is also going to display media controls for Task Manager, permitting its users to manage different multimedia applications readily just with a single click of a mouse. If there is the media player application running at the back end and one is surfing the Internet using Firefox, they will be able to control the app by simply moving over its Task Manager entry. By doing this, a live thumbnail will come up with support for media controls. It also has support for several media players.

KDE Plasma 5.6 is scheduled for release by March 22, 2016.

Huawei's open source platform for smart home devices



Huawei has plans of entering the smart home arena in 2016 with the rollout of its HiLink open source platform. In lieu of making the hardware as well as the software for smart homes, the company will offer only software along with the core chipset to power devices.

This platform is geared towards Internet of Things (IoT) products, or Web-connected home devices, including washing machines and refrigerators that are going to become quite common in the years to come. The HiLink SDK (software development kit), along with its LiteOS, is expected to be in the market by the second quarter of 2016.

Huawei has formed an alliance with Haier BroadLink in order to enter the smart home segment. The company will offer the chipset with its software to run smart home devices on the HiLink platform. Huawei stated that its Kirin 930 and 950 chips will be utilised in these devices.

The smart home category is presumed to be the next big leap in the smart devices industry. Apple is already present here with its HomeKit, and Samsung is expected to follow suit, as well.

Citrix opts out of the cloud server business

Citrix has sold its CloudPlatform and CloudPortal Business Manager product offerings to Accelerite on January 11, 2016.



According to Steve Wilson, VP and GM, converged infrastructure at Citrix, "We at Citrix are extremely confident that Accelerite will help nurture our customers, who are heavily invested in running their public, commercial clouds on these solutions, and will allow Citrix to focus on our core priorities around the secure delivery of apps and data."

Citrix's CloudPlatform technology is structured on the Apache CloudStack open source project, which the company had assisted in starting. The CloudStack code was contributed by Citrix to the Apache Software Foundation in April 2012. Citrix acquired the technology by acquiring cloud.com in July 2011. The company was a big supporter of its Project Olympus effort at the start; however, it retraced its steps in 2012 for CloudStack.

However, though Citrix may have sold off its CloudPlatform assets, it isn't exiting the cloud altogether. The company's aim is towards supporting an array of technologies to enable customers to select public, private or hybrid cloud technologies.